

Facilitator guide — Visualizations & Interpretation

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About these activities

These activities teach participants to **read a chart and say what it means** — first manually, then with the AI, ending in a real apply activity on country data. They deliberately pair a "do it yourself" path with an "AI does it, you verify" path, for both building charts and writing interpretations.

Six handouts. ~100 min of participant time.

How to run it

- Start with the **reading framework** (handout 1) — it is the reference everything else builds on.
- The sequence pairs **a full manual pass** (handouts 2 + 3) with **a full AI pass** (handouts 4 + 5), so participants complete the whole build-and-interpret loop themselves before they see the AI do it.
- For each platform task, **demo it first**, then let participants follow the handout. The handout re-explains what you showed.
- The through-line: the AI is fast, but the participant is accountable. Reinforce verification every time the AI appears.

The activities

1. How to read a FASTR visualization

Reference · ~10 min

What it is — a reusable reference: a six-step framework for reading any chart.

What the handout covers — the six steps (indicator, level/period, comparison, values, what stands out, so-what), how to choose chart types, and practice on an existing deck with a teammate.

Watch for — misreading the y-axis is the single most common mistake. Remind participants to check the legend, axes and footnotes *before* interpreting.

2. Create your first visualization

Activity · ~15 min

What it is — a hands-on activity creating a chart with the built-in builder (the **Metric** → **Presets** → **Create** wizard).

What the handout covers — + Create visualization → pick a metric (e.g. *M3. Service utilization* → *Number of services reported*) → choose a ready preset like *Service volume over time (monthly)* → Create. It then explains **filter vs disaggregate**, where to find them when editing a viz, and the four display modes (Lines / Grid / Rows / Columns).

Watch for — participants confuse **filter** (pick what to show — you tick the indicators/period you want) with **disaggregate** (break a total into its parts). Reinforce the difference out loud; it underlies every chart they build. The quick path is metric → preset → Create; **Custom** is only for manual control. Also: line charts for trends, bar charts for comparing.

Demo — use both, live (~3 min). Open a saved viz and show the **left panel** (point out you have to *scroll* to reach these — this is where people get lost):

1. Start with one indicator, national total. Say in words what it shows.
2. Under **Display (disaggregate)**, break it down **by district** — switch between **Lines**, then **Rows**, then **Grid** so they see the *same data in different shapes*.
3. Under **Filter (subset)**, tick just two districts — the chart shows only those. Name it: "I'm *choosing what to show*."
4. **Show the trap:** disaggregate by district **and** filter to a single district → nothing left to compare. Rule to repeat: *filter what you don't need, disaggregate what you want to compare*.

3. Write an interpretation for a chart

Activity · ~20 min

What it is — a writing activity teaching the three-part interpretation structure for a slide.

What the handout covers — a message-carrying title, a facts-only "what you see", and an action-oriented "what it means", added alongside a chart on a slide.

Watch for — titles that merely describe ("Coverage results"), facts mixed with interpretation, and vague so-whats that name no person or next step.

4. Build a visualization with the AI Assistant

Activity · ~15 min

What it is — a hands-on activity producing the same chart via plain-language AI requests.

What the handout covers — type a chart request, review whether the AI matched the ask (indicator, period, adjusted vs raw), iterate in short turns, and save.

Watch for — participants trust the first answer. They must verify indicator, period, chart type — and especially **adjusted vs raw data** — before saving.

5. Let the AI draft the interpretation

Activity · ~15 min

What it is — a hands-on activity using the AI to draft interpretation text, then verifying it.

What the handout covers — prompt the AI for an interpretation, verify each claim against the chart, refine in plain language, and add local context the AI cannot know.

Watch for — trusting confident-sounding AI text. Every claim must be checked against the chart, and the recommended action must be owned by the participant.

6. Apply — spot a disruption

Activity · ~25 min

What it is — a capstone apply activity using real country data to identify a disruption and write a finding.

What the handout covers — country teams pick a flagged indicator, open its disruption chart, work the six-step framework, add local context, write a three-part finding, and share it with the room.

Watch for — a disruption is rarely a single-month dip. Steer teams toward sustained drops (3+ months); remind them that stable volumes can still mean falling coverage if population is growing.

Wrapping up

Activity 6 is the proof these activities worked: a team that can pick a real disruption and state it clearly has the core FASTR skill. Use the share-back to surface and correct weak findings.